ANTI-HARASSMENT POLICY AND COMPLAINT PROCEDURE

Objective

BlockExcel strives to create and maintain a work environment in which people are treated with dignity, decency, and respect. The environment of the company should be characterized by mutual trust and the absence of intimidation, oppression, and exploitation. BlockExcel will not tolerate unlawful discrimination or harassment of any kind. Through enforcement of this policy and by education of employees, BlockExcel will seek to prevent, correct, and discipline behavior that violates this policy.

All employees, regardless of their positions, are covered by and are expected to comply with this policy and to take appropriate measures to ensure that prohibited conduct does not occur. Appropriate disciplinary action will be taken against any employee who violates this policy. Based on the seriousness of the offense, disciplinary action may include verbal or written reprimand, suspension, or termination of employment.

Managers and supervisors who knowingly allow or tolerate discrimination, harassment or retaliation, including the failure to immediately report such misconduct to human resources (HR), are in violation of this policy and subject to discipline.

Prohibited Conduct Under This Policy

BlockExcel, in compliance with all applicable national, state and local anti-discrimination and harassment laws and regulations, enforces this policy in accordance with the following definitions and guidelines:

Discrimination

It is a violation of BlockExcel's policy to discriminate in the provision of employment opportunities, benefits or privileges; to create discriminatory work conditions; or to use discriminatory evaluative standards in employment if the basis of that discriminatory treatment is, in whole or in part, the person's race (including hairstyle/texture), color, national origin, age, religion, disability status, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, genetic information or marital status.

Discrimination in violation of this policy will be subject to disciplinary measures up to and including termination.

Harassment

BlockExcel prohibits harassment of any kind, including sexual harassment, and will take appropriate and immediate action in response to complaints or knowledge of violations of this policy. For purposes of this policy, harassment is any verbal or physical conduct designed to threaten, intimidate or coerce an employee, co-worker, or any person working for or on behalf of BlockExcel.

The following examples of harassment are intended to be guidelines and are not exclusive when determining whether there has been a violation of this policy:

- Verbal harassment includes comments that are offensive or unwelcome regarding a person's national origin, race, color, religion, age, sex, sexual orientation, pregnancy, appearance, disability, gender identity or expression, marital status or other protected status, including epithets, slurs and negative stereotyping.
- Nonverbal harassment includes distribution, display or discussion of any written or graphic material that ridicules, denigrates, insults, belittles or shows hostility, aversion or disrespect toward an individual or group because of national origin, race, color, religion, age, gender, sexual orientation, pregnancy, appearance, disability, sexual identity, marital status or other protected status.

Sexual harassment

Sexual harassment is a form of unlawful employment discrimination under Title VII of the Civil Rights Act of 1964 and is prohibited under BlockExcel's anti-harassment policy. Sexual harassment is defined as "unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, and other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature, when submission to or rejection of such conduct is used as the basis for employment decisions or such conduct has the purpose or effect of creating an intimidating, hostile or offensive working environment.

Sexual harassment occurs when unsolicited and unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, or other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature:

- Is made explicitly or implicitly a term or condition of employment.
- Is used as a basis for an employment decision.
- Unreasonably interferes with an employee's work performance or creates an intimidating, hostile or otherwise offensive environment.

Sexual harassment may take different forms. The following examples of sexual harassment are intended to be guidelines and are not exclusive when determining whether there has been a violation of this policy:

- Verbal sexual harassment includes innuendoes, suggestive comments, jokes of a sexual nature, sexual propositions, lewd remarks and threats; requests for any type of sexual favor (this includes repeated, unwelcome requests for dates); and verbal abuse or "kidding" that is oriented toward a prohibitive form of harassment, including that which is sexual in nature and unwelcome.
- Nonverbal sexual harassment includes the distribution, display or discussion of any written or graphic material, including calendars, posters and cartoons that are sexually suggestive or show hostility toward an individual or group because of sex; suggestive or insulting sounds; leering; staring; whistling; obscene gestures; content in letters, notes, facsimiles, e-mails, photos, text messages, tweets and Internet postings; or other forms of communication that are sexual in nature and offensive.
- Physical sexual harassment includes unwelcome, unwanted physical contact, including touching, tickling, pinching, patting, brushing up against, hugging, cornering, kissing, fondling, and forced sexual intercourse or assault.

Courteous, mutually respectful, pleasant, noncoercive interactions between employees that are appropriate in the workplace and acceptable to and welcomed by both parties are not considered to be harassment, including sexual harassment.

Consensual Romantic or Sexual Relationships

BlockExcel strongly discourages romantic or sexual relationships between a manager or other supervisory employee and an employee who reports directly or indirectly to that person, because such relationships tend to create compromising conflicts of interest or the appearance of such conflicts. In addition, such a relationship may give rise to the perception by others that there is favoritism or bias in employment decisions affecting the staff employee. Moreover, given the uneven balance of power within such relationships, consent by the staff member is suspect and may be viewed by others, or at a later date by the staff member, as having been given as the result of coercion or intimidation. The atmosphere created by such appearances of bias, favoritism, intimidation, coercion or exploitation undermines the spirit of trust and mutual respect that is essential to a healthy work environment. If there is such a relationship, the parties need to be aware that one or both may be moved to a different department or other actions may be taken.

If any employee of BlockExcel enters into a consensual relationship that is romantic or sexual in nature with an employee who reports directly or indirectly to that employee, or if one of the parties is in a supervisory capacity in the same department in which the other party works, the parties must notify the HR director or other appropriate corporate officer. Because of potential issues regarding quid pro quo harassment, BlockExcel has made reporting mandatory. This requirement does not apply to employees who do not work in the same department or to parties where neither one supervises or otherwise manages responsibilities over the other.

Once the relationship is made known to BlockExcel, the company will review the situation with human resources in light of all the facts (reporting relationship between the parties, effect on co-workers, job titles of the parties, etc.) and will determine whether one or both parties need to be moved to another job or department. If it is determined that one party must be moved, and there are jobs in other departments available for both, the parties may decide who will be the one to apply for a new position. If the parties cannot amicably come to a decision, or the

party is not chosen for the position to which he or she applied, the HR director and senior management will decide which party will be moved. That decision will be based on which move will be least disruptive to the organization as a whole. If no other jobs are available for either party, the parties will be given the option of terminating their relationship or resigning.

Retaliation

No hardship, loss, benefit or penalty may be imposed on an employee in response to:

- Filing or responding to a bona fide complaint of discrimination or harassment.
- Appearing as a witness in the investigation of a complaint.
- Serving as an investigator of a complaint.

Lodging a bona fide complaint will in no way be used against the employee or have an adverse impact on the individual's employment status. However, filing groundless or malicious complaints is an abuse of this policy and will be treated as a violation.

Any person who is found to have violated this aspect of the policy will be subject to discipline up to and including termination of employment.

Confidentiality

All complaints and investigations are treated confidentially to the extent possible, and information is disclosed strictly on a need-to-know basis. The identity of the complainant is usually revealed to the parties involved during the investigation, and the HR director will take adequate steps to ensure that the complainant is protected from retaliation during and after the investigation. All information pertaining to a complaint or investigation under this policy will be maintained in secure files within the HR department.

Complaint procedure

BlockExcel has established the following procedure for lodging a complaint of harassment, discrimination or retaliation. The company will treat all aspects of the procedure confidentially to the extent reasonably possible.

1. Complaints should be submitted as soon as possible after an incident has occurred, preferably in writing. The HR director may assist the complainant in completing a written statement or, in the event an employee refuses to provide information in writing, the HR director will dictate the verbal complaint.
2. Upon receiving a complaint or being advised by a supervisor or manager that violation of this policy may be occurring, the HR director will notify senior management and review the complaint with the company's legal counsel.
3. The HR director will initiate an investigation to determine whether there is a reasonable basis for believing that the alleged violation of this policy occurred.
4. If necessary, the complainant and the respondent will be separated during the course of the investigation, either through internal transfer or administrative leave.
5. During the investigation, the HR director, together with legal counsel or other management employees, will interview the complainant, the respondent and any witnesses to determine whether the alleged conduct occurred.
6. Upon conclusion of an investigation, the HR director or other person conducting the investigation will submit a written report of his or her findings to the company. If it is determined that a violation of this policy has occurred, the HR director will recommend appropriate disciplinary action. The appropriate action will depend on the following factors:

a) the severity, frequency and pervasiveness of the conduct;

b) prior complaints made by the complainant;

c) prior complaints made against the respondent; and

d) the quality of the evidence (e.g., firsthand knowledge, credible corroboration).

If the investigation is inconclusive or if it is determined that there has been no violation of policy but potentially problematic conduct may have occurred, the HR director may recommend appropriate preventive action.

7. Senior management will review the investigative report and any statements submitted by the complainant or respondent, discuss results of the investigation with the HR director and other management staff as appropriate, and decide what action, if any, will be taken.
8. Once a final decision is made by senior management, the HR director will meet with the complainant and the respondent separately and notify them of the findings of the investigation. If disciplinary action is to be taken, the respondent will be informed of the nature of the discipline and how it will be executed.

Alternative legal remedies

Nothing in this policy may prevent the complainant or the respondent from pursuing formal legal remedies or resolution through legal agencies or the courts.

Note: BlockExcel policies and practices are regularly reviewed and updated to keep our organization up to date with the latest regulations and technology, as well as consistent with the industry's best practices.

ATTENDANCE POLICY

Objective

The purpose of this policy is to set forth BlockExcel's policy and procedures for handling employee absences and tardiness to promote the efficient operation of the company and minimize unscheduled absences.

Policy

Punctual and regular attendance is an essential responsibility of each employee at BlockExcel. Employees are expected to report to work as scheduled, on time and prepared to start working.

Employees also are expected to remain at work for their entire work schedule. Late arrival, early departure or other absences from scheduled hours are disruptive and must be avoided.

Absence

"Absence" is defined as the failure of an employee to report for work when he or she is scheduled to work. The two types of absences are defined below:

- *Excused absence* occurs when all the following conditions are met:

- The employee provides to his or her supervisor sufficient notice at least 48 hours in advance of the absence.
- The absence request is approved in advance by the employee's supervisor.

- The employee has sufficient accrued paid time off (PTO) to cover the absence.

- *Unexcused absence* occurs when any of the above conditions are not met. If it is necessary for an employee to be absent or late for work because of an illness or an emergency, the employee must notify his or her supervisor no later than the employee's scheduled starting time on that same day. If the employee is unable to call, he or she must have someone make the call.

An unexcused absence counts as one occurrence for the purposes of discipline under this policy.

Employees with three or more consecutive days of excused absences *because of illness or injury* must give BlockExcel proof of physician's care and a fitness for duty release prior to returning to work.

Employees must take earned PTO for every absence unless otherwise allowed by company policy (e.g., leave of absence, bereavement, etc.).

Tardiness and Early Departures

Employees are expected to report to work and return from scheduled breaks on time. If employees cannot report to work as scheduled, they must notify their supervisor no later than their regular starting time. This notification does not excuse the tardiness but simply notifies the supervisor that a schedule change may be necessary.

Employees who must leave work before the end of their scheduled shift must notify a supervisor immediately.

Tardiness and early departures are each one-half an occurrence for the purpose of discipline under this policy.

Disciplinary Action

Excessive absenteeism is defined as two or more occurrences of unexcused absence in a 30-day period and will result in disciplinary action. Eight occurrences of unexcused absence in a 12-month period are considered grounds for termination.

Job Abandonment

Any employee who fails to report to work for a period of three days or more without notifying his or her supervisor will be considered to have abandoned the job and voluntarily terminated the employment relationship.

Note: BlockExcel policies and practices are regularly reviewed and updated to keep our organization up to date with the latest regulations and technology, as well as consistent with the industry's best practices.

Build Trust and Credibility

The success of our business is dependent on the trust and confidence we earn from our employees, customers and shareholders. We gain credibility by adhering to our commitments, displaying honesty and integrity and reaching company goals solely through honorable conduct. It is easy to *say* what we must do, but the proof is in our *actions*. Ultimately, we will be judged on what we do.

When considering any action, it is wise to ask: Will this build trust and credibility for BlockExcel? Will it help create a working environment in which BlockExcel can succeed over the long term? Is the commitment I am making one I can follow through with? The only way we will maximize trust and credibility is by answering "yes" to those questions and by working every day to build our trust and credibility.

Respect for the Individual

We all deserve to work in an environment where we are treated with dignity and respect. BlockExcel is committed to creating such an environment because it brings out the full potential in each of us, which, in turn, contributes directly to our business success. We cannot afford to let anyone's talents go to waste.

BlockExcel is an equal employment/affirmative action employer and is committed to providing a workplace that is free of discrimination of all types and from abusive, offensive or harassing behavior. Any employee who feels harassed or discriminated against should report the incident to his or her manager or to human resources.

All BlockExcel employees are also expected to support an inclusive workplace by adhering to the following conduct standards:

- Treat others with dignity and respect at all times.
- Address and report inappropriate behavior and comments that are discriminatory, harassing, abusive, offensive or unwelcome.
- Foster teamwork and employee participation, encouraging the representation of different employee perspectives.
- Seek out insights from employees with different experiences, perspectives and backgrounds.

- Avoid slang or idioms that might not translate across cultures.
- Support flexible work arrangements for co-workers with different needs, abilities and/or obligations.
- Confront the decisions or behaviors of others that are based on conscious or unconscious biases.
- Be open-minded and listen when given constructive feedback regarding others' perception of your conduct.

BlockExcel will not tolerate discrimination, harassment or any behavior or language that is abusive, offensive or unwelcome.

Create a Culture of Open and Honest Communication

At BlockExcel everyone should feel comfortable to speak his or her mind, particularly with respect to ethics concerns. Managers have a responsibility to create an open and supportive environment where employees feel comfortable raising such questions. We all benefit tremendously when employees exercise their power to prevent mistakes or wrongdoing by asking the right questions at the right times.

BlockExcel will investigate all reported instances of questionable or unethical behavior. In every instance where improper behavior is found to have occurred, the company will take appropriate action. We will not tolerate retaliation against employees who raise genuine ethics concerns in good faith.

For your information, BlockExcel's whistleblower policy is as follows:

[Note to employer: This policy should have already been adopted as an addendum to the organization's handbook.]

Employees are encouraged, in the first instance, to address such issues with their managers or the HR manager, as most problems can be resolved swiftly. If for any reason that is not possible or if an employee is not comfortable raising the issue with his or her manager or HR, BlockExcel's [Title of Executive Officer] does operate with an open-door policy.

Set Tone at the Top

Management has the added responsibility for demonstrating, through their actions, the importance of this Code. In any business, ethical behavior does not simply happen; it is the

product of clear and direct communication of behavioral expectations, modeled from the top and demonstrated by example. Again, ultimately, our actions are what matters.

To make our Code work, managers must be responsible for promptly addressing ethical questions or concerns raised by employees and for taking the appropriate steps to deal with such issues. Managers should not consider employees' ethics concerns as threats or challenges to their authority, but rather as another encouraged form of business communication. At BlockExcel, we want the ethics dialogue to become a natural part of daily work.

Uphold the Law

BlockExcel's commitment to integrity begins with complying with laws, rules and regulations where we do business. Further, each of us must have an understanding of the company policies, laws, rules and regulations that apply to our specific roles. If we are unsure of whether a contemplated action is permitted by law or BlockExcel policy, we should seek the advice from the resource expert. We are responsible for preventing violations of law and for speaking up if we see possible violations.

Because of the nature of our business, some legal requirements warrant specific mention here.

Competition

We are dedicated to ethical, fair and vigorous competition. We will sell BlockExcel products and services based on their merit, superior quality, functionality and competitive pricing. We will make independent pricing and marketing decisions and will not improperly cooperate or coordinate our activities with our competitors. We will not offer or solicit improper payments or gratuities in connection with the purchase of goods or services for BlockExcel or the sales of its products or services, nor will we engage or assist in unlawful boycotts of particular customers.

Proprietary Information

It is important that we respect the property rights of others. We will not acquire or seek to acquire improper means of a competitor's trade secrets or other proprietary or confidential information. We will not engage in unauthorized use, copying, distribution or alteration of software or other intellectual property.

Selective Disclosure

We will not selectively disclose (whether in one-on-one or small discussions, meetings, presentations, proposals or otherwise) any material nonpublic information with respect to BlockExcel, its securities, business operations, plans, financial condition, results of operations or any development plan. We should be particularly vigilant when making presentations or

proposals to customers to ensure that our presentations do not contain material nonpublic information.

Health and Safety

BlockExcel is dedicated to maintaining a healthy environment. A safety manual has been designed to educate you on safety in the workplace. If you do not have a copy of this manual, please see the HR department.

Avoid Conflicts of Interest

Conflicts of Interest

We must avoid any relationship or activity that might impair, or even appear to impair, our ability to make objective and fair decisions when performing our jobs. At times, we may be faced with situations where the business actions we take on behalf of BlockExcel may conflict with our own personal or family interests. We owe a duty to BlockExcel to advance its legitimate interests when the opportunity to do so arises. We must never use BlockExcel property or information for personal gain or personally take for ourselves any opportunity that is discovered through our position with BlockExcel.

Here are some other ways in which conflicts of interest could arise:

1. Being employed (you or a close family member) by, or acting as a consultant to, a competitor or potential competitor, supplier or contractor, regardless of the nature of the employment, while you are employed with BlockExcel.
2. Hiring or supervising family members or closely related persons.
3. Serving as a board member for an outside commercial company or organization.
4. Owning or having a substantial interest in a competitor, supplier or contractor.
5. Having a personal interest, financial interest or potential gain in any BlockExcel transaction.
6. Placing company business with a firm owned or controlled by a BlockExcel employee or his or her family.
7. Accepting gifts, discounts, favors or services from a customer/potential customer, competitor or supplier, unless equally available to all BlockExcel employees.

Determining whether a conflict of interest exists is not always easy to do. Employees with a conflict of interest question should seek advice from management. Before engaging in any

activity, transaction or relationship that might give rise to a conflict of interest, employees must seek review from their managers or the HR department.

Gifts, Gratuities and Business Courtesies

BlockExcel is committed to competing solely on the merit of our products and services. We should avoid any actions that create a perception that favorable treatment of outside entities by BlockExcel was sought, received or given in exchange for personal business courtesies. Business courtesies include gifts, gratuities, meals, refreshments, entertainment or other benefits from persons or companies with whom BlockExcel does or may do business. We will neither give nor accept business courtesies that constitute, or could reasonably be perceived as constituting, unfair business inducements that would violate law, regulation or policies of BlockExcel or customers, or would cause embarrassment or reflect negatively on BlockExcel's reputation.

Accepting Business Courtesies

Most business courtesies offered to us in the course of our employment are offered because of our positions at BlockExcel. We should not feel any entitlement to accept and keep a business courtesy. Although we may not use our position at BlockExcel to obtain business courtesies, and we must never ask for them, we may accept unsolicited business courtesies that promote successful working relationships and good will with the firms that BlockExcel maintains or may establish a business relationship with.

Employees who award contracts or who can influence the allocation of business, who create specifications that result in the placement of business or who participate in negotiation of contracts must be particularly careful to avoid actions that create the appearance of favoritism or that may adversely affect the company's reputation for impartiality and fair dealing. The prudent course is to refuse a courtesy from a supplier when BlockExcel is involved in choosing or reconfirming a supplier or under circumstances that would create an impression that offering courtesies is the way to obtain BlockExcel business.

Meals, Refreshments and Entertainment

We may accept occasional meals, refreshments, entertainment and similar business courtesies that are shared with the person who has offered to pay for the meal or entertainment, provided that:

- They are not inappropriately lavish or excessive.
- The courtesies are not frequent and do not reflect a pattern of frequent acceptance of courtesies from the same person or entity.

- The courtesy does not create the appearance of an attempt to influence business decisions, such as accepting courtesies or entertainment from a supplier whose contract is expiring in the near future.
- The employee accepting the business courtesy would not feel uncomfortable discussing the courtesy with his or her manager or co-worker or having the courtesies known by the public.

Gifts

Employees may accept unsolicited gifts, other than money, that conform to the reasonable ethical practices of the marketplace, including:

- Flowers, fruit baskets and other modest presents that commemorate a special occasion.
- Gifts of nominal value, such as calendars, pens, mugs, caps and t-shirts (or other novelty, advertising or promotional items).

Generally, employees may not accept compensation, honoraria or money of any amount from entities with whom BlockExcel does or may do business. Tangible gifts (including tickets to a sporting or entertainment event) that have a market value greater than $100 may not be accepted unless approval is obtained from management.

Employees with questions about accepting business courtesies should talk to their managers or the HR department.

Offering Business Courtesies

Any employee who offers a business courtesy must assure that it cannot reasonably be interpreted as an attempt to gain an unfair business advantage or otherwise reflect negatively upon BlockExcel. An employee may never use personal funds or resources to do something that cannot be done with BlockExcel resources. Accounting for business courtesies must be done in accordance with approved company procedures.

Other than to our government customers, for whom special rules apply, we may provide nonmonetary gifts (i.e., company logo apparel or similar promotional items) to our customers. Further, management may approve other courtesies, including meals, refreshments or entertainment of reasonable value, provided that:

- The practice does not violate any law or regulation or the standards of conduct of the recipient's organization.
- The business courtesy is consistent with industry practice, is infrequent in nature and is not lavish.

- The business courtesy is properly reflected on the books and records of BlockExcel.

Set Metrics and Report Results Accurately

Accurate Public Disclosures

We will make certain that all disclosures made in financial reports and public documents are full, fair, accurate, timely and understandable. This obligation applies to all employees, including all financial executives, with any responsibility for the preparation for such reports, including drafting, reviewing and signing or certifying the information contained therein. No business goal of any kind is ever an excuse for misrepresenting facts or falsifying records.

Employees should inform Executive Management and the HR department if they learn that information in any filing or public communication was untrue or misleading at the time it was made or if subsequent information would affect a similar future filing or public communication.

Corporate Recordkeeping

We create, retain and dispose of our company records as part of our normal course of business in compliance with all BlockExcel policies and guidelines, as well as all regulatory and legal requirements.

All corporate records must be true, accurate and complete, and company data must be promptly and accurately entered in our books in accordance with BlockExcel's and other applicable accounting principles.

We must not improperly influence, manipulate or mislead any unauthorized audit, nor interfere with any auditor engaged to perform an internal independent audit of BlockExcel books, records, processes or internal controls.

Promote Substance Over Form

At times, we are all faced with decisions we would rather not have to make and issues we would prefer to avoid. Sometimes, we hope that if we avoid confronting a problem, it will simply go away.

At BlockExcel, we must have the courage to tackle the tough decisions and make difficult choices, secure in the knowledge that BlockExcel is committed to doing the right thing. At times this will mean doing more than simply what the law requires. Merely because we can pursue a course of action does not mean we *should* do so.

Although BlockExcel's guiding principles cannot address every issue or provide answers to every dilemma, they can define the spirit in which we intend to do business and should guide us in our daily conduct.

Accountability

Each of us is responsible for knowing and adhering to the values and standards set forth in this Code and for raising questions if we are uncertain about company policy. If we are concerned whether the standards are being met or are aware of violations of the Code, we must contact the HR department.

BlockExcel takes seriously the standards set forth in the Code, and violations are cause for disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment.

Be Loyal

Confidential and Proprietary Information

Integral to BlockExcel's business success is our protection of confidential company information, as well as nonpublic information entrusted to us by employees, customers and other business partners. Confidential and proprietary information includes such things as pricing and financial data, customer names/addresses or nonpublic information about other companies, including current or potential supplier and vendors. We will not disclose confidential and nonpublic information without a valid business purpose and proper authorization.

Use of Company Resources

Company resources, including time, material, equipment and information, are provided for company business use. Nonetheless, occasional personal use is permissible as long as it does not affect job performance or cause a disruption to the workplace.

Employees and those who represent BlockExcel are trusted to behave responsibly and use good judgment to conserve company resources. Managers are responsible for the resources assigned to their departments and are empowered to resolve issues concerning their proper use.

Generally, we will not use company equipment such as computers, copiers and fax machines in the conduct of an outside business or in support of any religious, political or other outside daily activity, except for company-requested support to nonprofit organizations. We will not solicit contributions nor distribute non-work related materials during work hours.

In order to protect the interests of the BlockExcel network and our fellow employees, BlockExcel reserves the right to monitor or review all data and information contained on an employee's company-issued computer or electronic device, the use of the Internet or BlockExcel's intranet. We will not tolerate the use of company resources to create, access, store, print, solicit or send any materials that are harassing, threatening, abusive, sexually explicit or otherwise offensive or inappropriate.

Questions about the proper use of company resources should be directed to your manager.

Media Inquiries

BlockExcel is a high-profile company in our community, and from time to time, employees may be approached by reporters and other members of the media. In order to ensure that we speak with one voice and provide accurate information about the company, we should direct all media inquiries to the [Public Relations Executive]. No one may issue a press release without first consulting with the [Public Relations Executive].

Do the Right Thing

Several key questions can help identify situations that may be unethical, inappropriate or illegal. Ask yourself:

- Does what I am doing comply with the BlockExcel guiding principles, Code of Conduct and company policies?
- Have I been asked to misrepresent information or deviate from normal procedure?
- Would I feel comfortable describing my decision at a staff meeting?
- How would it look if it made the headlines?
- Am I being loyal to my family, my company and myself?
- What would I tell my child to do?
- Is this the right thing to do?

Note: BlockExcel policies and practices are regularly reviewed and updated to keep our organization up to date with the latest regulations and technology, as well as consistent with the industry's best practices.

BRING YOUR OWN DEVICE (BYOD) POLICY

Objective

This policy establishes BlockExcel guidelines for employee use of personally owned electronic devices for work-related purposes.

Scope

Employees of BlockExcel may have the opportunity to use their personal electronic devices for work purposes when authorized in writing, in advance, by the employee and BlockExcel management. Personal electronic devices include personally owned cellphones, smartphones, tablets, laptops and computers.

The use of personal devices is limited to certain employees and may be limited based on compatibility of technology. Contact the human resource (HR) department for more details.

Procedure

Device protocols

To ensure the security of BlockExcel information, authorized employees are required to have anti-virus and mobile device management (MDM) software installed on their personal mobile devices. This MDM software will store all company-related information, including calendars, e-mails and other applications in one area that is password-protected and secure. BlockExcel's IT department must install this software prior to using the personal device for work purposes.

Employees may store company-related information only in this area. Employees may not use cloud-based apps or backup that allows company-related data to be transferred to unsecure parties. Due to security issues, personal devices may not be synchronized with other devices in employees' homes. Making any modifications to the device hardware or software beyond authorized and routine installation updates is prohibited unless approved by IT. Employees may not use unsecure Internet sites.

All employees must use a preset ringtone and alert for company-related messages and calls. Personal devices should be turned off or set to silent or vibrate mode during meetings and conferences and in other locations where incoming calls may disrupt normal workflow.

Restrictions on authorized use

Employees whose personal devices have camera, video or recording capability are restricted from using those functions anywhere in the building or on company property at any time unless authorized in advance by management.

While at work, employees are expected to exercise the same discretion in using their personal devices as is expected for the use of company devices. BlockExcel policies pertaining to harassment, discrimination, retaliation, trade secrets, confidential information and ethics apply to employee use of personal devices for work-related activities.

Excessive personal calls, e-mails or text messaging during the workday, regardless of the device used, can interfere with employee productivity and be distracting to others. Employees must handle personal matters on nonwork time and ensure that friends and family members are aware of the policy. Exceptions may be made for emergency situations and as approved in advance by management. Managers reserve the right to request employees' cellphone bills and use reports for calls and messaging made during working hours to determine if use is excessive.

Nonexempt employees may not use their personal devices for work purposes outside of their normal work schedule without authorization in advance from management. This includes reviewing, sending and responding to e-mails or text messages, responding to phone calls, or making phone calls.

Employees may not use their personal devices for work purposes during periods of unpaid leave without authorization from management. BlockExcel reserves the right to deactivate the company's application and access on the employee's personal device during periods of unpaid leave.

An employee may not store information from or related to former employment on the company's application.

Family and friends should not use personal devices that are used for company purposes.

Privacy/company access

No employee using his or her personal device should expect any privacy except that which is governed by law. BlockExcel has the right, at any time, to monitor and preserve any communications that use the BlockExcel's networks in any way, including data, voice mail, telephone logs, Internet use and network traffic, to determine proper use.

Management reserves the right to review or retain personal and company-related data on personal devices or to release the data to government agencies or third parties during an investigation or litigation. Management may review the activity and analyze use patterns and may choose to publicize these data to ensure that BlockExcel's resources in these areas are

being used according to this policy. Furthermore, no employee may knowingly disable any network software or system identified as a monitoring tool.

Company stipend

Employees authorized to use personal devices under this policy will receive an agreed-on monthly stipend based on the position and estimated use of the device. If an employee obtains or currently has a plan that exceeds the monthly stipend, BlockExcel will not be liable for the cost difference.

Safety

Employees are expected to follow applicable national, local, state and international laws and regulations regarding the use of electronic devices at all times.

Employees whose job responsibilities include regular or occasional driving are expected to refrain from using their personal devices while driving. Regardless of the circumstances, including slow or stopped traffic, employees are required to pull off to the side of the road and safely stop the vehicle before placing or accepting a call or texting. Special care should be taken in situations involving traffic, inclement weather or unfamiliar areas.

Employees who are charged with traffic violations resulting from the use of their personal devices while driving will be solely responsible for all liabilities that result from such actions.

Employees who work in hazardous areas must refrain from using personal devices while at work in those areas, as such use can potentially be a major safety hazard.

Lost, stolen, hacked or damaged equipment

Employees are expected to protect personal devices used for work-related purposes from loss, damage or theft.

In an effort to secure sensitive company data, employees are required to have “remote-wipe” software installed on their personal devices by the IT department prior to using the devices for work purposes. This software allows the company-related data to be erased remotely in the event the device is lost or stolen. Wiping company data may affect other applications and data.

BlockExcel will not be responsible for loss or damage of personal applications or data resulting from the use of company applications or the wiping of company information. Employees must immediately notify management in the event their personal device is lost, stolen or damaged. If IT is unable to repair the device, the employee will be responsible for the cost of replacement.

Employees may receive disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment for damage to personal devices caused willfully by the employee.

Termination of employment

Upon resignation or termination of employment, or at any time on request, the employee may be asked to produce the personal device for inspection. All company data on personal devices will be removed by IT upon termination of employment.

Violations of policy

Employees who have not received authorization in writing from BlockExcel management and who have not provided written consent will not be permitted to use personal devices for work purposes. Failure to follow BlockExcel policies and procedures may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

Note: BlockExcel policies and practices are regularly reviewed and updated to keep our organization up to date with the latest regulations and technology, as well as consistent with the industry's best practices.

EMPLOYEE CODE OF CONDUCT POLICY

Objective

BlockExcel adopts this Employee Conduct and Work Rules Policy to ensure orderly operations and provide the best possible work environment. BlockExcel expects employees and others who are engaged to provide services, such as temporary personnel, consultants and independent contractors, to follow these rules of conduct while on company premises, attending company functions or otherwise performing work-related activity.

In addition to maintaining and enforcing this policy to protect the interests and safety of all employees and the organization, BlockExcel complies with all applicable federal, state and local laws and regulations concerning employer/employee rights and obligations.

Procedures

BlockExcel is responsible for providing a safe and secure workplace and strives to ensure that all individuals associated with the company are treated in a respectful and fair manner. Though it is not possible to list all forms of behavior that are unacceptable in the workplace, the following are examples of behavior that would be considered infractions of BlockExcel rules of conduct. Such behavior may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment. This list is not intended to be exhaustive:

1. Theft or inappropriate removal or possession of company property or the property of a fellow employee.
2. Willful destruction of company property or the property of a fellow employee.
3. Working under the influence of alcohol or illegal drugs.
4. Possession, distribution, sale, transfer or use of alcohol or illegal drugs in the workplace, while on duty or while operating employer-owned vehicles or equipment.
5. Fighting or threatening violence in the workplace.
6. Sexual or other harassment.

7. Using excessively abusive, threatening, or obscene language.

8. Using intimidation tactics and making threats.

9. Sabotaging another's work.

10. Making malicious, false, and harmful statements about others.

11. Publicly disclosing another's private information.

12. Possession of dangerous or unauthorized materials, such as explosives or firearms, in the workplace.

13. Unauthorized disclosure of business "secrets" or confidential information.

14. Falsifying company records or reports, including one's time records or the time records of another employee.

Note: BlockExcel policies and practices are regularly reviewed and updated to keep our organization up to date with the latest regulations and technology, as well as consistent with the industry's best practices.

USE AND MONITORING OF COMPANY PROPERTY POLICY

Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to ensure that all property maintained by BlockExcel is kept in the best possible working condition and to ensure proper use of such property and BlockExcel networks.

"Property," as the term is used in this policy, is defined as any piece of equipment, furnishing, vehicle, building or supply leased, owned, donated or otherwise in the custodial care of BlockExcel or any person acting as its agent.

No BlockExcel employee should expect any privacy on BlockExcel premises or when using BlockExcel property or networks, except that which is required by law.

General Guidelines on the Use of Company Property

All BlockExcel employees must maintain their work environment in an orderly fashion and follow all BlockExcel rules to ensure its proper use and maintenance.

Any employee who is found to have neglected or misused BlockExcel property will be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination. If an employee's misuse of BlockExcel property damages the property, BlockExcel reserves the right to require the employee to pay all or part of the cost to repair or replace the property. Misappropriation of BlockExcel property is grounds for immediate termination and possible criminal action.

No employee may use BlockExcel property (including but not limited to computers, telephones, cellphones, copiers, faxes, Internet services and printers) for personal use unless specific permission has been granted by the employee's department head. If such permission is granted, the employee will be responsible for the care and return of the loaned property. Special care should be taken to identify any concerns regarding its condition before the property is removed or used by the employee for personal use.

Use of Company Vehicles

Any employee for whom driving is an essential job duty must be authorized and approved by BlockExcel Transport Dept. to drive BlockExcel vehicles. It is the responsibility of the employee driver of a BlockExcel vehicle to ensure that the vehicle is in full operational condition before each use. The employee driver will sign a vehicle log report noting any problems with, or damage to, the vehicle before each use. Should the employee return the vehicle to the company with damage to the vehicle, the vehicle log report will be used as support evidence of the condition of the vehicle before it was used by the employee driver. Any vehicle found to be

unsafe will be removed from the operational fleet until appropriate maintenance or repairs have occurred.

Use and Dissemination of Company Information

"Information," as the term is used in this policy, includes without limitation any information owned or used by BlockExcel, such as:

- Any company employee, customer or client lists.
- Any company database information, including addresses and telephone numbers.
- Any information from BlockExcel employee personnel files, including employee addresses, telephone numbers, employment status and wage history.
- Any photographs, videos, and sound clips of any BlockExcel employee, customer or client.

Only those employees who are authorized by BlockExcel's board of directors or executive team, or whose job description permits them to do so, may speak on behalf of BlockExcel. Notwithstanding the foregoing, specific permission from the BlockExcel's board of directors or executive team will be required before any BlockExcel employee may disseminate confidential BlockExcel information.

No employee may knowingly dispense such information to any outside party unless authorization has been granted. This could include other employees who do not have the right to know such information. Any breach will be considered a violation of BlockExcel policy concerning confidentiality, and it may constitute a violation of state or federal law.

Monitoring of Network Communications

BlockExcel reserves the right to monitor at any time any communications that use BlockExcel networks in any way, including data, voice mail, email, telephone logs, Internet use and network traffic, to determine proper use.

BlockExcel will review network communications activity and will analyze use patterns. BlockExcel may choose to publish these data to ensure that company resources in these areas are being used according to this policy.

No employee may knowingly disable any network software or system identified as a monitoring tool.

Note: BlockExcel policies and practices are regularly reviewed and updated to keep our organization up to date with the latest regulations and technology, as well as consistent with the industry's best practices.

PERSONAL IDENTITY INFORMATION (PII) SECURITY, NOTIFICATION AND CONFIDENTIALITY POLICY

Purpose

BlockExcel recognizes its need to maintain the confidentiality of Personal Identity Information (PII) and understands that such information is unique to each individual. The PII covered by this policy may come from various types of individuals performing tasks on behalf of the company and includes employees, applicants, independent contractors and any PII maintained on its customer base. The scope of this policy is intended to be comprehensive and will include company requirements for the security and protection of such information throughout the company and its approved vendors both on and off work premises.

Departments named in this policy have delegated authority for developing and implementing procedural guidance for ensuring that their departmental responsibilities under this policy are communicated and enforced.

Key Elements

Personal Identity Information (PII): Unique personal identification numbers or data, including:

- Identification numbers, such as Aadhaar number, Voter ID, etc., (or their equivalent issued by governmental entities outside India).
- Taxpayer Identification Numbers such as PAN number (or their equivalent issued by governmental revenue entities outside India).
- Employer Identification Numbers (or their equivalent issued by government entities outside India).
- State or foreign drivers license numbers.

- Date(s) of birth.
- Corporate or individually held credit or debit transaction card numbers (including PIN or access numbers) maintained in organizational or approved vendor records.

PII may reside in hard copy or electronic records; both forms of PII fall within the scope of this policy.

Vendors: Individual(s) or companies that have been approved by the Contracts Department as a recipient of organizational PII and from which the Contracts Department has received certification of their data protection practices conformance with the requirements of this policy. Vendors include all external providers of services to the company and include proposed vendors. No PII information can be transmitted to any vendor in any method unless the vendor has been pre-certified for the receipt of such information.

PII Retention: BlockExcel understands the importance of minimizing the amount of PII data it maintains and retains such PII only as long as necessary. A joint task force comprising members of the Legal, Finance, IT, Contracts and Human Resources departments maintains organizational record retention procedures, which dictate the length of data retention and data destruction methods for both hard copy and electronic records.

PII Training: All new hires entering the company who may have access to PII are provided with introductory training regarding the provisions of this policy, a copy of this policy and implementing procedures for the department to which they are assigned. Employees in positions with regular ongoing access to PII or those transferred into such positions are provided with training reinforcing this policy and procedures for the maintenance of PII data and shall receive annual training regarding the security and protection of PII data and company proprietary data.

PII Audit(s): BlockExcel conducts audits of PII information maintained by the company in conjunction with fiscal year closing activities to ensure that this policy remains strictly enforced and to ascertain the necessity for the continued retention of PII information. Where the need no longer exists, PII information will be destroyed in accordance with protocols for destruction of such records and logs maintained for the dates of destruction. The audits are conducted by Finance, IT, Contracts and Human Resources departments under the auspices of the Legal department.

Data Breaches/Notification: Databases or data sets that include PII may be breached inadvertently or through wrongful intrusion. Upon becoming aware of a data breach, the company will notify all affected individuals whose PII data may have been compromised, and the notice will be accompanied by a description of action being taken to reconcile any damage as a result of the data breach. Notices will be provided as expeditiously as possible and in no

event be later than the commencement of the payroll period after which the breach was discovered.

The Legal department will handle breach notifications(s) to all governmental agencies to whom such notice must be provided in accordance with time frames specified under these laws. Notices to affected individuals will be communicated by Human Resources after consultation with the Legal department and within the time frame specified under the appropriate law(s).

Data Access: BlockExcel maintains multiple IT systems where PII data may reside; thus, user access to such IT systems is the responsibility of the IT department. The IT department has created internal controls for such systems to establish legitimate access for users of data, and access shall be limited to those approved by IT. Any change in vendor status or the termination of an employee or independent contractor with access will immediately result in the termination of the user's access to all systems where the PII may reside.

Data Transmission and Transportation

1. Company Premises Access to PII: The Finance, Human Resources and IT departments have defined responsibilities for on-site access of data that may include access to PII; IT has the oversight responsibility for all electronic records and data access capabilities. Finance and Human Resources have the operational responsibility for designating initial access and termination of access for individual users within their organizations and providing timely notice to IT.

2. Vendors: BlockExcel may share data with vendors who have a business need to have PII data. Where such inter-company sharing of data is required, the IT department is responsible for creating and maintaining data encryption and protection standards to safeguard all PII data that resides in the databases provided to vendors. Approved vendor lists will be maintained by the Contracts department, and Contracts has responsibility to notify IT of any changes to vendor status with the company.

3. Portable Storage Devices: BlockExcel reserves the right to restrict PII data it maintains in the workplace. In the course of doing business, PII data may also be downloaded to laptops or other computing storage devices to facilitate company business. To protect such data, the company will also require that any such devices use IT department-approved encryption and security protection software while such devices are in use on or off company premises. The IT department has responsibility for maintaining data encryption and data protection standards to safeguard PII data that resides on these portable storage devices.

4. Off-Site Access to PII: BlockExcel understands that employees may need to access PII while off site or on business travel, and access to such data shall not be prohibited, subject to the provision that the data to be accessed is minimized to the degree possible to meet business needs and that such data shall reside only on assigned laptops/approved storage devices that have been secured in advance by the IT department.

Regulatory Requirements: It is the policy of the company to comply with any national, international, federal or state statute and reporting regulations. BlockExcel has delegated the responsibility for maintaining PII security provisions to the departments noted in this policy. BlockExcel Legal department shall be the sole entity named to oversee all regulatory reporting compliance issues. If any provision of this policy conflicts with a statutory requirement of national, international, federal or state law governing PII, the policy provision(s) that conflict shall be superseded.

Employee Hotline: If an employee has reason to believe that his or her PII (please refer to what constitutes PII) data security has been breached or that company representative(s) are not adhering to the provisions of this policy, an employee should contact the company legal counsel or contact an HR representative at the employee's location.

Confirmation of Confidentiality: All company employees must maintain the confidentiality of PII as well as company proprietary data to which they may have access and understand that that such PII is to be restricted to only those with a business need to know. Employees with ongoing access to such data will sign acknowledgement reminders annually attesting to their understanding of this company requirement.

Violations of PII Policies and Procedures: BlockExcel views the protection of PII data to be of the utmost importance. Infractions of this policy or its procedures will result in disciplinary actions under the company's discipline policy and may include suspension or termination in the case of severe or repeat violations. PII violations and disciplinary actions are incorporated in the company's PII onboarding and refresher training to reinforce the company's continuing commitment to ensuring that this data is protected by the highest standards.

Note: BlockExcel policies and practices are regularly reviewed and updated to keep our organization up to date with the latest regulations and technology, as well as consistent with the industry's best practices.

EMPLOYEE DISCIPLINARY ACTION POLICY

Purpose

BlockExcel's employee disciplinary action policy and procedures are designed to provide a structured corrective action process to improve and prevent a recurrence of undesirable employee behavior and performance issues.

Outlined below are the steps of BlockExcel's discipline policy and procedures.

BlockExcel reserves the right to combine or skip steps depending on the facts of each situation and the nature of the offense. Some of the factors that will be considered are whether the offense is repeated despite coaching, counseling, or training; the employee's work record; and the impact the conduct and performance issues have on the organization.

Nothing in this policy provides any contractual rights regarding employee discipline or counseling, nor should anything in this policy be read or construed as modifying or altering the employment-at-will relationship between BlockExcel and its employees.

Procedure

Step 1: Counseling and verbal warning

Step 1 creates an opportunity for the immediate supervisor to bring attention to the existing performance, conduct or attendance issue. The supervisor should discuss with the employee the nature of the problem or the violation of company policies and procedures. The supervisor is expected to clearly describe expectations and steps the employee must take to improve his or her performance or resolve the problem.

Within five business days, the supervisor will prepare written documentation of the verbal counseling. The employee will be asked to sign this document to demonstrate his or her understanding of the issues and the corrective action.

Step 2: Written warning

The Step 2 written warning involves more-formal documentation of the performance, conduct or attendance issues and consequences.

During Step 2, the immediate supervisor and a division manager or director will meet with the employee to review any additional incidents or information about the performance, conduct or attendance issues as well as any prior relevant corrective action plans. Management will outline the consequences for the employee of his or her continued failure to meet performance or conduct expectations.

A formal performance improvement plan (PIP) requiring the employee's immediate and sustained corrective action will be issued within five business days of a Step 2 meeting. The written warning may also include a statement indicating that the employee may be subject to additional discipline, up to and including termination, if immediate and sustained corrective action is not taken.

Step 3: Suspension and final written warning

Some performance, conduct or safety incidents are so problematic and harmful that the most effective action may be the temporary removal of the employee from the workplace. When immediate action is necessary to ensure the safety of the employee or others, the immediate supervisor may suspend the employee pending the results of an investigation.

Suspensions that are recommended as part of the normal sequence of the discipline policy and procedures are subject to approval from a next-level manager and HR.

Depending on the seriousness of the infraction, the employee may be suspended without pay in full-day increments consistent with employment laws. Nonexempt/hourly employees may not substitute or use an accrued paid vacation or sick day in lieu of the unpaid suspension. Unpaid suspension of salaried/exempt employees is reserved for serious workplace safety or conduct issues. HR will provide guidance to ensure that the discipline is administered without jeopardizing the employment / labor laws.

Pay may be restored to the employee if an investigation of the incident or infraction absolves the employee of wrongdoing.

Step 4: Recommendation for termination of employment

The last and most serious step in the progressive discipline process is a recommendation to terminate employment. Generally, BlockExcel will try to exercise the progressive nature of this policy by first providing warnings, issuing a final written warning or suspending the employee from the workplace before proceeding to a recommendation to terminate employment. However, BlockExcel reserves the right to combine and skip steps depending on the circumstances of each situation and the nature of the offense. Furthermore, employees may be terminated without prior notice or disciplinary action.

Management's recommendation to terminate employment must be approved by human resources (HR) and the division director or designate. Final approval may be required from the CEO or designate.

Appeals Process

Employees will have the opportunity to present information to dispute information management has used to issue disciplinary action. The purpose of this process is to provide insight into extenuating circumstances that may have contributed to the employee's performance or conduct issues while allowing for an equitable solution.

If the employee does not present this information during any of the step meetings, he or she will have five business days after each of those meetings to present such information.

Performance and Conduct Issues Not Subject to Progressive Discipline

Behavior that is illegal is not subject to progressive discipline and may result in immediate termination. Such behavior may be reported to local law enforcement authorities.

Similarly, theft, substance abuse, intoxication, fighting and other acts of violence at work are also not subject to progressive discipline and may be grounds for immediate termination.

Documentation

The employee will be provided copies of all progressive discipline documentation, including all PIPs. The employee will be asked to sign copies of this documentation attesting to his or her receipt and understanding of the corrective action outlined in these documents.

Copies of these documents will be placed in the employee's official personnel file.

Note: BlockExcel policies and practices are regularly reviewed and updated to keep our organization up to date with the latest regulations and technology, as well as consistent with the industry's best practices.

EQUAL EMPLOYMENT OPPORTUNITY POLICY

Objective

BlockExcel is an equal opportunity employer. In accordance with anti-discrimination law, it is the purpose of this policy to effectuate these principles and mandates. BlockExcel prohibits discrimination and harassment of any type and affords equal employment opportunities to employees and applicants without regard to race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, pregnancy, age, national origin, disability status, genetic information, protected veteran status, or any other characteristic protected by law. BlockExcel conforms to the spirit as well as to the letter of all applicable laws and regulations.

Scope

The policy of equal employment opportunity (EEO) and anti-discrimination applies to all aspects of the relationship between BlockExcel and its employees, including:

- Recruitment
- Employment
- Promotion
- Transfer
- Training
- Working conditions
- Wages and salary administration
- Employee benefits and application of policies

The policies and principles of EEO also apply to the selection and treatment of independent contractors, personnel working on our premises who are employed by temporary agencies and any other persons or firms doing business for or with BlockExcel.

Dissemination and Implementation of Policy

The officers of BlockExcel will be responsible for the dissemination of this policy. Directors, managers, and supervisors are responsible for implementing equal employment practices within each department. The HR department is responsible for overall compliance and will maintain personnel records in compliance with applicable laws and regulations.

Procedures

BlockExcel administers our EEO policy fairly and consistently by:

- Posting all required notices regarding employee rights under EEO laws in areas highly visible to employees
- Advertising for job openings with the statement "*We are an equal opportunity employer, and all qualified applicants will receive consideration for employment without regard to race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, pregnancy, age, national origin, disability status, genetic information, protected veteran status, or any other characteristic protected by law*"
- Posting all required job openings with the appropriate state agencies
- Forbidding retaliation against any individual who files a charge of discrimination, opposes a practice believed to be unlawful discrimination, reports harassment, or assists, testifies or participates in an EEO agency proceeding.
- Requires employees to report to a member of management, an HR representative or the general counsel any apparent discrimination or harassment. The report should be made within 48 hours of the incident
- Promptly notifies the general counsel of all incidents or reports of discrimination or harassment and takes other appropriate measures to resolve the situation

Harassment

Harassment is a form of unlawful discrimination and violates BlockExcel policy. Prohibited sexual harassment, for example, is defined as unwelcome sexual advances, request for sexual favors and other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature when:

- Submission to such conduct is made either explicitly or implicitly a term or condition of an individual's employment.
- Submission to or rejection of such conduct by an individual is used as the basis for employment decisions affecting such individuals.
- Such conduct has the purpose or effect of substantially interfering with an individual's work performance or creating an intimidating, hostile or offensive working environment.

Harassment also includes unwelcome conduct that is based on race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, pregnancy, age, national origin, disability status, genetic information, protected veteran status, or any other characteristic protected by law. Harassment becomes unlawful where:

- Enduring the offensive conduct becomes a condition of continued employment, or
- The conduct is severe or pervasive enough to create a work environment that a reasonable person would consider intimidating, hostile, or abusive.

BlockExcel encourages employees to report all incidents of harassment to a member of management or the HR department. BlockExcel conducts harassment prevention training for all employees, and maintains and enforces a separate policy on harassment prevention, complaint procedures and penalties for violations. BlockExcel investigates all complaints of harassment promptly and fairly, and, when appropriate, takes immediate corrective action to stop the harassment and prevent it from recurring.

Remedies

Violations of this policy, regardless of whether an actual law has been violated, will not be tolerated. BlockExcel will promptly, thoroughly, and fairly investigate every issue that is brought to its attention in this area and will take disciplinary action, when appropriate, up to and including termination of employment.

Note: BlockExcel policies and practices are regularly reviewed and updated to keep our organization up to date with the latest regulations and technology, as well as consistent with the industry's best practices.

EMPLOYEE FRATERNIZATION POLICY

Objective

BlockExcel strongly believes that a work environment where employees maintain clear boundaries between employee personal and business interactions is necessary for effective business operations.

Although this policy does not prevent the development of friendships or romantic relationships between co-workers, it does establish boundaries as to how relationships are conducted during working hours and within the working environment.

Individuals in supervisory or managerial roles and those with authority over others' terms and conditions of employment are subject to more stringent requirements under this policy due to their status as role models, their access to sensitive information, and their ability to affect the employment of individuals in subordinate positions.

This policy does not preclude or interfere with the rights of employees protected by the labor laws or any other applicable statute concerning the employment relationship.

Procedures

1. During working time and in working areas, employees are expected to conduct themselves in an appropriate workplace manner that does not interfere with others or with overall productivity.
2. During nonworking time, such as lunches, breaks, and before and after work periods, employees engaging in personal exchanges in nonwork areas should observe an appropriate workplace manner to avoid offending other workers or putting others in an uncomfortable position.
3. Employees are strictly prohibited from engaging in physical contact that would in any way be deemed inappropriate in the workplace by a reasonable person while anywhere on company premises, whether during working hours or not.
4. Employees who allow personal relationships with co-workers to adversely affect the work environment will be subject to BlockExcel's disciplinary policy, including counseling for minor problems. Failure to change behavior and maintain expected work responsibilities is viewed as a serious disciplinary matter.
5. Employee off-duty conduct is generally regarded as private, as long as such conduct does not create problems within the workplace. An exception to this principle, however, is romantic or sexual relationships between supervisors and subordinates.
6. Any supervisor, manager, executive or other company official in a sensitive or influential position with BlockExcel must disclose the existence of a romantic or sexual relationship with another co-worker. Disclosure may be made to the individual's immediate supervisor or the director of HR. BlockExcel will review the circumstances to determine whether any conflict of interest exists.
7. When a conflict-of-interest or potential risk is identified due to a company official's relationship with a co-worker, BlockExcel will work with the parties involved to consider

options for resolving the problem. The initial solution may be to make sure the parties no longer work together on matters where one is able to influence the other or take action for the other. Matters such as hiring, firing, promotions, performance management, compensation decisions and financial transactions are examples of situations that may require reallocation of duties to avoid any actual or perceived reward or disadvantage. In some cases, other measures may be necessary, such as transfer of one or both parties to other positions or departments. If one or both parties refuse to accept a reasonable solution, such refusal will be deemed a voluntary resignation.

8. Failure to cooperate with BlockExcel to resolve a conflict or problem caused by a romantic or sexual relationship between co-workers or among managers, supervisors or others in positions of authority in a mutually agreeable fashion may be deemed insubordination and result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.
9. The provisions of this policy apply regardless of the sexual orientation of the parties involved.
10. Where doubts exist as to the specific meaning of the terms used above, employees should make judgments based on the overall spirit and intent of this policy.
11. Any concerns about the administration of this policy should be addressed to the director of HR.

Note: BlockExcel policies and practices are regularly reviewed and updated to keep our organization up to date with the latest regulations and technology, as well as consistent with the industry's best practices.

GRIEVANCE ADDRESSAL POLICY AND PROCEDURES

Purpose

BlockExcel recognizes that there are times when the need arises for employees to express concerns or complaints in a formal manner. The following procedures will ensure that employees receive a fair and unbiased review of workplace concerns.

Procedures

Step 1: Informal discussion with supervisor

Employee concerns should first be discussed with the employee's immediate supervisor. Many concerns can be resolved informally when an employee and supervisor take time to review the concern and discuss options to address the issue.

Step 2: Written complaint to supervisor

If the employee is not satisfied with the results of the informal discussion in Step 1, the employee may submit a written complaint within five days to his or her immediate supervisor to include:

§ The nature of the grievance.

§ Detailed information including evidence of the issue, witnesses, related policies, etc.

§ The remedy or outcome desired.

The immediate supervisor will have five working days to respond to the employee in writing.

If the employee complaint is regarding illegal harassment, discrimination or retaliation, the employee should submit the written complaint directly to Human Resources.

Step 3: Written complaint to senior management

If the employee is not satisfied with the response from the immediate supervisor, the employee may submit a written complaint to senior management for review. A copy should also be sent to Human Resources. The request for review should include:

- An explanation of the grievance and details of all previous efforts to resolve the issue.
- A copy of the written complaint submitted to the immediate supervisor.
- A copy of the immediate supervisor's written response to the employee's complaint.
- Detailed information regarding the employee's dissatisfaction with the immediate supervisor's response.

Senior management will consult with the employee's immediate supervisor, Human Resources and any other relevant parties to evaluate the grievance and provide a written response to the employee within five days. The outcome of the review by senior management will be final unless new evidence or other circumstances warrant additional review of the complaint.

Recordkeeping

Human resources will maintain records of the grievance process confidentially and securely.

Note: BlockExcel policies and practices are regularly reviewed and updated to keep our organization up to date with the latest regulations and technology, as well as consistent with the industry's best practices.

REMOTE-WORK CONDUCT POLICY

As our workforce continues to operate with some or all employees working at locations other than BlockExcel offices, the following expectations for employees are being clarified to avoid issues that may cause disruption to the workday and/or during virtual meetings.

General Expectations

- Remote employees are expected to be available and communicative during scheduled work hours.
- BlockExcel work rules and other policies continue to apply to offsite work locations.
- Consumption of alcohol during work hours is never acceptable.
- Employees should seek a quiet and distraction-free working space, to the extent possible.
- Employees are expected to maintain their workspace in a safe manner, free from safety hazards.

Virtual Meetings

- While distractions are often unavoidable, try to keep them to a minimum. No music or television in the background during meetings.
- Keep yourself muted during video or audio conferencing unless you are speaking.
- Turning on video is encouraged and may be mandatory as required in some cases, but not always.
- Avoid eating a meal during a virtual meeting unless invited to do so by the meeting host.
- Smoking or vaping is not permitted during a video conference.
- Casual dress is acceptable; however, use discretion. No sleeveless tops, pajamas or other apparel that would not be appropriate to wear outside of your home.
- Avoid multi-tasking. Give your full attention to the meeting as if you were face to face.

We appreciate the effort that all of our employees have shown in the transition to remote work, and we hope these guidelines help to clarify BlockExcel's expectations when teleworking.

While gentle reminders may be all that is necessary in some circumstances, egregious or continued violations of these expectations and/or other BlockExcel policies will result in disciplinary action.

Note: BlockExcel policies and practices are regularly reviewed and updated to keep our organization up to date with the latest regulations and technology, as well as consistent with the industry's best practices.

SUBSTANCE ABUSE, DRUG AND ALCOHOL POLICY

Purpose

In compliance with the national drug laws, BlockExcel has a longstanding commitment to provide a safe, quality-oriented and productive work environment. Alcohol and drug misuse poses a threat to the health and safety of BlockExcel employees and to the security of the company's equipment and facilities. For these reasons, BlockExcel is committed to the elimination of drug and alcohol use and misuse in the workplace.

Scope

This policy applies to all employees and all applicants for employment of BlockExcel. The human resource (HR) department is responsible for policy administration.

Employee Assistance

BlockExcel will assist and support employees who voluntarily seek help for drug or alcohol addiction before becoming subject to discipline or termination under this or other BlockExcel

policies. Such employees will be allowed to use accrued paid time off, placed on leaves of absence, referred to treatment providers and otherwise accommodated as required by law. Employees may be required to document that they are successfully following prescribed treatment and to take and pass follow-up tests if they hold jobs that are safety-sensitive or require driving, or if they have violated this policy previously. Once a drug test has been initiated under this policy, the employee will have forfeited the opportunity to be granted a leave of absence for treatment, and will face possible discipline, up to and including discharge.

Employees should report to work fit for duty and free of any adverse effects of illegal drugs or alcohol. This policy does not prohibit employees from the lawful use and possession of prescribed medications. Employees must, however, consult with their doctors about the medications' effect on their fitness for duty and ability to work safely, and they must promptly disclose any work restrictions to their supervisor.

Work Rules

1. Whenever employees are working, are operating any BlockExcel vehicle, are present on BlockExcel premises or are conducting company-related work offsite, they are prohibited from:
    a. Using, possessing, buying, selling, manufacturing or dispensing an illegal drug (to include possession of drug paraphernalia).
    b. Being under the influence of alcohol or an illegal drug as defined in this policy.
    c. Possessing or consuming alcohol.
2. The presence of any detectable amount of any illegal drug, illegal controlled substance or alcohol in an employee's body system, while performing company business or while in a company facility, is prohibited.
3. BlockExcel will also not allow employees to perform their duties while taking prescribed drugs that are adversely affecting their ability to perform their job duties safely and effectively. Employees taking a prescribed medication must carry it in a container labeled by a licensed pharmacist or be prepared to produce the container if asked.
4. Any illegal drugs or drug paraphernalia will be turned over to an appropriate law enforcement agency and may result in criminal prosecution.

Required Testing

Pre-employment

Applicants being considered for hire must pass a drug test before beginning work or receiving an offer of employment. Refusal to submit to testing will result in disqualification of further employment consideration.

Reasonable suspicion

Employees are subject to testing based on, but not limited to, observations of apparent workplace use, possession or impairment by at least two members of management. HR, the plant manager or the director of operations should be consulted before sending an employee for testing. Management must use the reasonable suspicion observation checklist to document specific observations and behaviors that create a reasonable suspicion that an employee is under the influence of illegal drugs or alcohol. Examples include:

- Odors (smell of alcohol, body odor or urine).
- Movements (unsteady, fidgety, dizzy).
- Eyes (dilated, constricted or watery eyes, or involuntary eye movements).
- Face (flushed, sweating, confused or blank look).
- Speech (slurred, slow, distracted mid-thought, inability to verbalize thoughts).
- Emotions (argumentative, agitated, irritable, drowsy).
- Actions (yawning, twitching).
- Inactions (sleeping, unconscious, no reaction to questions).

When reasonable suspicion testing is warranted, both management and HR will meet with the employee to explain the observations and the requirement to undergo a drug and/or alcohol test within two hours. Refusal by an employee will be treated as a positive drug test result and will result in immediate termination of employment.

Under no circumstances will the employee be allowed to drive himself or herself to the testing facility. A member of management must transport the employee or arrange for a cab and arrange for the employee to be transported home.

Post-accident

Employees are subject to testing when they cause or contribute to accidents that seriously damage a BlockExcel vehicle, machinery, equipment or property or that result in an injury to themselves or another employee requiring offsite medical attention. A circumstance that constitutes probable belief will be presumed to arise in any instance involving a work-related accident or injury in which an employee who was operating a motorized vehicle (examples

include, but not limited to, a BlockExcel forklift, pickup truck, overhead crane or aerial/man-lift, etc.) is found to be responsible for causing the accident. In any of these instances, the investigation and subsequent testing must take place within two hours following the accident, if not sooner. Refusal by an employee will be treated as a positive test result and will result in immediate termination of employment.

Under no circumstances will the employee be allowed to drive himself or herself to the testing facility. A member of management must transport the employee or arrange for a cab and arrange for the employee to be transported home.

Collection and Testing Procedures

Employees subject to alcohol testing will be transported to a BlockExcel-designated facility and directed to provide breath specimens. Breath specimens will be tested by trained technicians using approved breath alcohol testing devices capable of producing printed results that identify the employee. If an employee's breath alcohol concentration is more than the permitted legal amount, a second breath specimen will be tested approximately 20 minutes later. The results of the second test will be determinative. Alcohol tests may, however, be a breath, blood or saliva test, at the company's discretion. For purposes of this policy, test results generated by law enforcement or medical providers may be considered by the company as work rule violations.

Applicants and employees subject to drug testing will be transported to a BlockExcel-designated testing facility and directed to provide urine specimens. Applicants and employees may provide specimens in private unless they appear to be submitting altered, adulterated or substitute specimens. Collected specimens will be sent to a certified laboratory and tested for evidence of marijuana, cocaine, opiates, amphetamines, PCP, benzodiazepines, methadone, methaqualone and propoxyphene use. (Where indicated, specimens may be tested for other illegal drugs.) The laboratory will screen all specimens and confirm all positive screens. There must be a chain of custody from the time specimens are collected through testing and storage.

The laboratory will transmit all positive drug test results to a medical review officer (MRO) retained by BlockExcel, who will offer individuals with positive results a reasonable opportunity to rebut or explain the results. Individuals with positive test results may also ask the MRO to have their split specimen sent to another federally certified laboratory to be tested at the applicant's or employee's own expense. Such requests must be made within 72 hours of notice of test results. If the second facility fails to find any evidence of drug use in the split specimen, the employee or applicant will be treated as passing the test. In no event should a positive test result be communicated to BlockExcel until such time that the MRO has confirmed the test to be positive.

Consequences

Applicants who refuse to cooperate in a drug test or who test positive will not be hired and will not be allowed to reapply/retest in the future.

Employees who refuse to cooperate in required tests or who use, possess, buy, sell, manufacture or dispense an illegal drug in violation of this policy will be terminated. If the employee refuses to be tested, yet the company believes he or she is impaired, under no circumstances will the employee be allowed to drive himself or herself home.

Employees who test positive, or otherwise violate this policy, will be subject to discipline, up to and including termination. Depending on the circumstances, the employee's work history/record and any state law requirements, BlockExcel may offer an employee who violates this policy or tests positive the opportunity to return to work on a last-chance basis pursuant to mutually agreeable terms, which could include follow-up drug testing at times and frequencies determined by BlockExcel for a minimum of one year but not more than two years as well as a waiver of the right to contest any termination resulting from a subsequent positive test. If the employee either does not complete the rehabilitation program or tests positive after completing the rehabilitation program, the employee will be immediately discharged from employment.

Employees will be paid for time spent in alcohol or drug testing and then suspended pending the results of the drug or alcohol test. After the results of the test are received, a date and time will be scheduled to discuss the results of the test; this meeting will include a member of management, and HR. Should the results prove to be negative, the employee will receive back pay for the times/days of suspension.

Confidentiality

Information and records relating to positive test results, drug and alcohol dependencies, and legitimate medical explanations provided to the MRO will be kept confidential to the extent required by law and maintained in secure files separate from normal personnel files. Such records and information may be disclosed among managers and supervisors on a need-to-know basis and may also be disclosed when relevant to a grievance, charge, claim or other legal proceeding initiated by or on behalf of an employee or applicant.

Inspections

BlockExcel reserves the right to inspect all portions of its premises for drugs, alcohol or other contraband. All employees, contract employees and visitors may be asked to cooperate in inspections of their persons, work areas and property that might conceal a drug, alcohol or other contraband. Employees who possess such contraband or refuse to cooperate in such inspections are subject to appropriate discipline, up to and including discharge.

Crimes Involving Drugs

BlockExcel prohibits all employees, including employees performing work under government contracts, from manufacturing, distributing, dispensing, possessing or using an illegal drug in or on company premises or while conducting company business. BlockExcel employees are also prohibited from misusing legally prescribed or over-the-counter (OTC) drugs. Law enforcement personnel may be notified, as appropriate, when criminal activity is suspected.

BlockExcel does not desire to intrude into the private lives of its employees but recognizes that employees' off-the-job involvement with drugs and alcohol may have an impact on the workplace. Therefore, BlockExcel reserves the right to take appropriate disciplinary action for drug use, sale or distribution while off company premises. All employees who are convicted of, plead guilty to or are sentenced for a crime involving an illegal drug are required to report the conviction, plea or sentence to HR within five days. Failure to comply will result in automatic discharge. Cooperation in complying may result in suspension without pay to allow management to review the nature of the charges and the employee's past record with BlockExcel.

Definitions

"Company premises" includes all buildings, offices, facilities, grounds, parking lots, lockers, places and vehicles owned, leased or managed by BlockExcel or any site on which the company is conducting business.

"Illegal drug" means a substance whose use or possession is controlled by national/state law but that is not being used or possessed under the supervision of a licensed health care professional.

"Refuse to cooperate" means to obstruct the collection or testing process; to submit an altered, adulterated or substitute sample; to fail to show up for a scheduled test; to refuse to complete the requested drug testing forms; or to fail to promptly provide specimen(s) for testing when directed to do so, without a valid medical basis for the failure. Employees who leave the scene of an accident without justifiable explanation prior to submission to drug and alcohol testing will also be considered to have refused to cooperate and will automatically be subject to discharge.

"Under the influence of alcohol" means an alcohol concentration equal to or greater than the legally permitted level, or actions, appearance, speech or bodily odors that reasonably cause a supervisor to conclude that an employee is impaired because of alcohol use.

"Under the influence of drugs" means a confirmed positive test result for illegal drug use per this policy. In addition, it means the misuse of legal drugs (prescription and possibly OTC) when there is not a valid prescription from a physician for the lawful use of a drug in the course of

medical treatment (containers must include the patient's name, the name of the substance, quantity/amount to be taken and the period of authorization).

Enforcement

The HR director is responsible for policy interpretation, administration, and enforcement.

Note: BlockExcel policies and practices are regularly reviewed and updated to keep our organization up to date with the latest regulations and technology, as well as consistent with the industry's best practices.

LEAVES & HOLIDAYS POLICY

Introduction

This program document may be modified, revised, discontinued, or amended at any time, in whole or in part, for any reason and without prior notice, consent or approval within the sole discretion of BlockExcel. It is solely for use by and distribution to the individuals who are subject to this program.

The information provided in this publication is for information purposes only and does not constitute a contract of employment.

Eligibility

To apply for a leave of absence, you must be a salaried employee. Interns, temporary and seasonal employees, individuals who perform services as a contractor to BlockExcel are not eligible to participate.

1. National / Festival holidays

In keeping with the National and Festival Holidays Act, India employees will be paid 10 days per calendar year as holidays. This will be as-per a pre-published holiday calendar. For further information, employees can access the Holiday Calendar via this link: https://blockexcel.com/people/holiday.php

2. Paid Time Off (PTO)

The Company provides the following leave for all regular employees.

- Vacation Leave
- Sick Leave

3. Vacation Leave

India employees will be provided with **1** Vacation Leave every month (**12 days** of annual leave per calendar year). Any unused vacation leaves will carry over to the next calendar year up to a maximum of 45 days. Once it reaches this number, there will be no further accrual of leaves. The approval and scheduling of such time off will be subject to prior Manager Approval and business needs.

Upon termination of employment, any remaining balance of vacation leave shall be encashed to the exiting employee. All vacation leave/annual leave will be paid out to the exiting employee at the employee's fixed salary rate at the time of exit.

4. Sick Leave

BlockExcel will provide India employees up to **8** days of paid sick time per calendar year. Employees availing sick leave must inform their manager no later than the time they are scheduled to start work that day. Any sick time- off taken in excess of an employee's paid sick time can be availed from casual/ vacation leave on prior approval. Employees can apply for leaves through https://payroll.razorpay.com/dashboard

LEAVE WITHOUT PAY (LWP)

All India employees are eligible for leave without pay described below at the discretion of the employee's ground business leader after taking into account client service needs, office operations and any other such factor that impacts the business. BlockExcel will make every effort consistent with good business practice to grant requests for such unpaid personal leave.

However, there may be situations where it cannot be granted due to client service or business needs. In order to participate in any of the leaves below you must first exhaust any accrued PTO.

During the period of LWP, the employee will not receive any compensation but will continue to be eligible for all other benefits. Also, employees on LWP will not earn any PTO credit for the unpaid personal leave period.

In case the LWP extends beyond 30 calendar days, it will be considered as Leave of Absence, wherein employees will not be eligible for any benefits except insurance. At the end of 30 calendar days of LWP, if the employee does not return to work upon completion of the leave, he/she shall be considered to have voluntarily resigned as of the last day of work unless the employee has obtained approval for availing Leave of Absence.

Employee will not be paid for National Festivals/Holidays that occur during his/her LWP period. Employees must seek approval from their Manager before availing LWP. Once the approval is obtained, employees can apply for leaves through https://payroll.razorpay.com/dashboard

BEREAVEMENT LEAVE

The Company recognizes that employees may need time off following the death of a family member. The Company will provide for 7 days of bereavement leave with pay in the event of the death:

Spouse/common law partner, parents, siblings and children, Spouse/common law partner's parents, siblings and children, Grandparents, Grandchildren

Employee needs to notify his/her Manager immediately if he/she takes a bereavement leave. The employee also would need to give his/her contact details to the Manager so that Manager can contact the employee during the absence in case of an emergency. Employees can apply for leaves through https://payroll.razorpay.com/dashboard

LEAVE OF ABSENCE (Medical LOA, Personal LOA)

All regular employees are eligible for this program.

For availing the Leave of Absence Program, the employee should request written approval of the manager. Once approved, Employees can apply for leaves through https://payroll.razorpay.com/dashboard. The Manager will need to discuss with the Group Head and Human Resources Head and approve the Leave of Absence as appropriate.

- During the period of unpaid LOA, the employee will not receive any compensation.

· Employee shall only be eligible for all insurance during LOA. When the employee returns to work on the first working day after his / her leave has expired, he / she shall not service credit for the entire leave period over and above the first 30 days. If the employee does not return to work upon completion of the leave, he/she shall be considered to have voluntarily resigned as of last day of work unless under justifiable circumstances.

· Upon the return to work, BlockExcel shall make every effort to reinstate the employee in his / her present position or in an equivalent or comparable position in the Company and at a salary that is not less than his/ her last drawn salary prior to the employee's leave. However, BlockExcel cannot guarantee employee's job while he/she is on a Leave of Absence.

· Business conditions may necessitate BlockExcel filling employee's position. This will depend upon the business requirements of the Company. During the period of the employee's absence, his/her obligations under the "confidential information and intellectual property agreement" with BlockExcel will continue to be in effect. Employee should not be involved in employment that would constitute a conflict of interest.

MEDICAL LEAVE OF ABSENCE

· Employee will need to request Medical Leave of Absence if an illness, surgery or other medical event keeps the employee away from work longer than 10 consecutive business days. The first ten days off from work shall be deducted from the employee's Personal Time Off/Sick leave.

· When the employee requests for the leave on medical grounds (eg: to recoup after major illness or for the postnatal care), Manager will need to approve leave post consultation with the Group Head and Business Partner.

· The effective date of the employee's Medical Leave would be the date when the doctor advises him/her not to work. Medical Leave would be granted for period that is medically necessary, as documented by the physician for the employee to be away from work.

· This period would be a maximum of 12 months from the onset of the illness, surgery, disability or other medical event.

· If the employee is not returning to work after a total of 12 months of disability, his/her employment with BlockExcel shall terminate at the end of the 12-month period.

· Any extension of leave so granted is subject to approval from the Managing Director/Sr Director.

· To apply for Medical Leave, the employee will need Manager's approval on email and once approval is obtained, Employees can apply for leaves through https://payroll.razorpay.com/dashboard

· The manager will need to ensure that a certification of disability (signed by his/her doctor, certifying illness and the expected duration of disability) is submitted by the employee.

· Recurrent Disability - Successive periods of Medical Leave shall be considered one period of Medical Leave, as long as it results from related causes and is separated by a return to work of less than six months. In such a case, the employee will not have to use his/her PTO, again for the first week of a recurrent disability. For example, if the employee is on disability leave for a total of ten months and returns to work after four months, again goes out on a Medical Leave for the same or a related cause, then the employee shall have two months available for his/her Medical Leave of Absence.

· If the employee's disability continues beyond twelve months, his/her employment with BlockExcel will end.

· Extension of Medical Leave of Absence- While the employee is on Medical Leave, it is suggested to be in touch with his/her Manager and the ERC regarding the status of his/her return. If employee's doctor does not permit to return to work on the expected return date, the

employee must provide ERC with a statement certifying his inability to return to work. The statement will indicate the new expected date of return to work. Also, this statement must be provided on /before the original anticipated date of return. Failure to return to work within three days of the expected date of return shall normally be deemed as a resignation from the employment by the employee and BlockExcel shall terminate the employee.

· Returning to work from medical leave of absence- When the employee returns to work, he/she will need to provide his/her Manager and the ERC function with the doctor's release statement before he/she is allowed to return to work. This note will need to include any limitations or restrictions on the employee's ability to execute his/her job and the estimated duration of those limitations. If necessary, the employee and his/her doctor are encouraged to provide recommendations regarding the steps BlockExcel can take to reasonably accommodate any medical limitations the employee may have. The ERC team shall work with the employee and his/her doctor on whether the accommodation can be made and shall make the determination of what is appropriate and reasonable. Upon the employee's return from leave, he/she shall be reinstated to his/her original or a substantially comparable position and shall receive pay and benefits equivalent to those received prior to the Medical Leave. If his/her former or comparable position is not available due to business reasons, he/she may be eligible to receive compensation and benefits in lieu of and depending upon the business circumstances that necessitated his/her job elimination.

· While on Leave, the employee needs to be in contact with his/her Manager to know if the former position or a comparably similar position is available.

· If the employee's doctor suggests that he/she should work on part-time basis return to work, then the doctor must certify the number of hours the employee must work each day. The certification should also include any such restriction that shall affect the employee's job and the estimated duration of these restrictions.

PERSONAL LEAVE OF ABSENCE

Leave without Pay for more than 30 calendar days is considered as Personal Leave of Absence. Group Head (Dir/Dir+) level approval is required for LOA. LOA impacts:

· If any full-time regular employee wishes to take time away from BlockExcel for educational pursuits, extended vacations or other personal reasons, he/she is eligible to request an unpaid Personal Leave of Absence.

· If granted, Personal Leave of Absence is granted for a maximum of six months with a possible extension of an additional six months.

· During the period of unpaid personal leave, the employee will not receive any compensation.

· Personal Leave of Absence will be granted subject to completion of 365 days of continuous service with the Company He/she may be granted Personal Leave of Absence, if he/she is an employee in good standing, as determined by BlockExcel, and the business conditions can accommodate his/her request. Any deviation from this clause will be subject to approval from the Managing Director/Senior Director

· The employee will need approval from manager and once approved, Employees can apply for leaves through https://payroll.razorpay.com/dashboard before the leave is to begin.

Returning from a personal leave - Upon return to work, BlockExcel shall make every effort to reinstate the employee in his/her present position or in an equivalent or comparable position in the Company and at a salary that is not less than the employee's last drawn salary prior to the leave. However, BlockExcel cannot guarantee job while is on a Personal Leave of Absence. The employee will need to stay in touch with his/her Manager and the ERC Team.

If the employee's position is filled during the period he/she is on leave, the employee can apply for another position within the Company, however will need to compete with other equally qualified active employees. If at the end of the employee's scheduled Personal Leave of Absence his/her position is filled, then the employee's employment at BlockExcel will be terminated.

If the employee is on an approved Personal Leave of Absence, and accepts a position in another Company, he/she shall be deemed to have voluntarily resigned from his/her employment with BlockExcel.

Request for Personal Leave of Absence is reviewed on a case-to-case basis and is dependent on the discretion of the management team and HR.

Employee shall not be paid for any for National /Festival holidays that fall during the personal leave of absence.

PTO accrual shall be suspended for the length of employee's unpaid leave in excess of 30 calendar days.

LOA impacts, AIP, service date and sabbatical eligibility date. During LOA of insurance benefits are extended to employees.

The benefits within the retirement schemes - PF and gratuity will continue during the Leave Without Pay. However, there shall be no contributions made to these schemes during the period.

Note:

" As per our standard protocols we shall be sharing medical documents with our team of internal medical practitioners (or concerned third party) for further consultation & advice."

"Company reserves the right to ask for supporting medical documents for any of the following leaves types (Sick leave/Medical LOA, Illness arising out of pregnancy, Miscarriage.)"

"You must apply all your leaves on https://payroll.razorpay.com/dashboard *as soon as you have availed them. You will not be able to apply leaves on* https://payroll.razorpay.com/dashboard *which are older than 3 months or if the calendar*

year changes. Not marking time off on the system within the prescribed timelines is a policy violation as it leads to incorrect leave balance & related payroll implications. Failure to act in accordance with the policy guidelines and protocols may lead to disciplinary actions as appropriate, hence we expect you to adhere to the said guidelines."

BlockExcel policies and practices are regularly reviewed and updated to keep our organization up to date with the latest regulations and technology, as well as consistent with the industry's best practices.